ETCSL 5.5.4 — The song of the hoe

- **Editors:** ETCSL project (J. Black, G. Cunningham, E. Robson, G. Zólyomi et al.), Oxford 1998–2006.
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.5.5.4&display=Crit&charenc=gcirc ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.5.5.4 ; ORACC: https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/epsd2/literary/Q000778 (lemmatised copy with morph in `../../ORACC/epsd2-literary--Q000778--*/`)
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16. The XML was copied from the local OTA 2518 bulk corpus (`../_bulk/etcsl-unzipped/etcsl/`); the live site and the Wayback HTML displays were not fetched this time (the XML is authoritative).
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Content

Enlil separates heaven from earth "to make the seed of the land come up from the earth" (1–7); at Uzumua ("where flesh grew") he puts the first humans' heads into the brick mould and they break through the earth (8–20); the Anuna praise the hoe; the hoe's deeds in building, agriculture and burial, a long chain of puns on *al* "hoe" (21–110).

Files

- `c.5.5.4.xml`, `t.5.5.4.xml` — ETCSL TEI source (2006 revised edition; lemmatised `<w form lemma pos label>`).
- `transliteration.md` (110 composite lines), `translation.md` — clean UTF-8 conversions by `../../../tools/etcsl2md.py`.

Manuscripts

Composite from 88 OB manuscripts (the best-attested text in this project); one damaged line.

Line numbering

ETCSL composite line numbers (110 lines). Translation paragraphs carry the line range they cover. Lines that only some manuscripts have are numbered with letters (e.g. `9A`) or given as variants in parentheses.

ETCSL bibliography (from the XML header)

- Kramer 1944 51-53; Farber 1997 (COS 1.157); Wilcke 1972 36-38; Civil 1969 70; Jacobsen 1946 134; Pettinato 1971 82-85; Civil 1994 (ll. 79, 85); Farber 1999, 2001.

Usefulness

Base text (rank 1) for the project `סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/2-טקסטי-בריאה-ועדן/`. ETCSL's prose translation is rank 3 (check only, after drafting).